THE BIG IDEA

If you want students to think deeply, you have to give them something to think about.

Deep thinking does not happen by accident. When students are working hard to make sense of something, it is because the lesson was built for it. **If you want students to think deeply, then they need:**

WHY IT MATTERS

Each need matches one component of the Engagement Blueprint. The left column gives students something worth thinking about. The right column gives them the people, space, and time to actually do the thinking. The next page uses the official language.

SOMETHING WORTH THINKING ABOUT

1A To see the big picture

Select the learning intention: content and concept

1B Something to think about

Analyze multiple artifacts and look for patterns

1C Something to prompt them

Use a high-cognitive prompt

ROOM TO DO THE THINKING

2A Someone to talk to about it

Intentionally group students

2B A place to make it visible

Provide open space to make thinking visible

2C Lots of time

Protect extended small-group discussion time

2D A way to make it stick

Reify learning as a class; students make notes

THE FRAMEWORK

The Engagement Blueprint

If we want to position students for cognitive engagement, **then** how do we need to teach?

APPLIES TO BOTH

Acquisition (content understanding) and meaning making (conceptual understanding).

1 Design for deeper learning

1A Select the learning intention: content and concept

BEFORE

Choose the facts and skills, plus the lesson-sized gist that organizes them.

1B Analyze multiple artifacts and look for patterns

DURING

Students compare rich artifacts to find patterns, relationships, and questions.

1C Use a high-cognitive prompt

DURING

Pose a question or statement that asks students to analyze, explain, or connect.

2 Design for student-centered learning

2A Intentionally group students

DURING

Form small, flexible, temporary groups that serve a clear purpose.

2B Provide open space to make thinking visible

DURING

Give groups a shared, open workspace where they build their own organization.

2C Protect extended small-group discussion time

DURING

Protect uninterrupted time to inspect evidence, revise ideas, and represent thinking.

2D Reify learning as a class; students make notes

AFTER

Turn group ideas into shared, accurate understanding; students make notes.